

Understanding the news

As teens start to take more interest in the world around them, they discover how to find news and learn to digest it. Seeking out various points of view on a news item helps a teen to have a balanced understanding of issues and politics.

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News media

Some news sources are more reliable than others. News items should be provided in a transparent and accountable way—this means they are examined critically, without any bias, and that the provider is responsible for what they report. The facts should be verified and the people they source the details from should be trustworthy. It's important to find out where news comes from before digesting its content.



△ Newspapers

A traditional medium of news, newspaper journalism follows a strict code of ethics to promote transparency.



△ News websites and apps

Websites and apps allow people to get news on demand. Some websites and apps are reliable, but a lack of regulation means many spread false information.



△ Social media

The lack of regulation on social media means that news released there is often misleading, unreliable, and without accountability.



△ Television

Traditionally a widely viewed news source, TV news has strict guidelines to ensure the news is properly sourced and verified.

Critical analysis

It's important to be critical about the news, rather than accepting everything as fact. Some news companies may focus heavily on negative news, or sensationalize stories and events in order to attract interest. Others may be biased toward a particular ideal or owned by people with an agenda. A company's owner might support a particular political party, for example, and want to influence voters in an election. All of this can lead to stereotyping and a narrow, selective presentation of events.

▷ Seeking answers

Questioning news outlets about their sponsorships, agendas, and transparency ensures they are held accountable for the content they broadcast.

Ask yourself

- Who put this information here, and why?
- Does the author have an agenda?
- Is it a sponsored news item? Or is the information sourced independently?
- Is there a balanced outline of viewpoints, with reliable evidence to support each argument?
- Are they asking questions and looking at detail, or making generalized statements?